Law and Order – Fairy Tale Unit

By Jonathan Rand

INTENSE VOICEOVER: **(Pg 43)** In the fairy tale criminal justice system, the characters from fairy tales and nursery rhymes are represented by two separate yet equally ridiculous groups: the fairy tale police who investigate fairy tale crime, and the fairy tale district attorneys who prosecute the fairy tale offenders. These are their stories.

INTRODUCTION

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CHUH-CHUNK: **(Pg 43-45)** Chuh-chunk. **LOCATION:** Chestnut and Hill. **TIME:** 7:26 A.M.

(A pile of rubble, entirely made of straw. CINDY and H.D. arrive on the scene, each with a cheap cup of coffee. CINDY wears only one shoe; H.D. has his arm in a sling, a bandage wrapped around his head, maybe some other bandages and some bruises.)

CINDY: . . . So what're we lookin' at . . . Accident?

ZELLE: Not a chance. Perp struck the property from the rear, letting loose some form of wind power. Hey, what's with the missing shoe?

CINDY: Eh, lost it last night at a Prince concert. *(Sings a line from a Prince Song while gyrating in some strange dance move. Realizes she's being unprofessional and stops, embarrassed. Resumes her professional persona)* Long story . . . . Any leads so far on our perp?

ZELLE: No dice. And the boys downtown got nothin' on the tenant either. But come take a look at this. *(She holds up some straw)* See this yellow-tinted, fibrous material here? We're stumped on what it might be.

HD: Let's have a look. *(He does)* The texture and appearance is almost straw-like in nature.

ZELLE: Whatever it is, the whole building was made out of it.

HD: What a mess . . .

CINDY: My gut's tellin' me someone's got a problem with the tenant, and for some reason, destroyed the place in retaliation.

HD: And whatever the reason- *(Beat)* it was the last straw . . .

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CINDY: **(Pg 50)** *(CINDY's phone rings. She takes it. Listens then hangs up. She turns to H.D.)*

Strike two. Downed building out in the boonies. We gotta fly. *(They exit)*

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(Pg 50-53) **CHUH-CHUNK:** Chuh-chunk. **LOCATION:** The Sticks. **TIME:** 9:37 A.M.

(H.D. and CINDY enter.)

UGLY D: Took you fellas long enough.

HD: What you got.

UGLY D: Well, I heard on the wire about the pile over on Chestnut. Based on that report and on the workmanship here, it looks like the same perp. Identical approach on the building from the backside; identical wind velocity. This time, though? Different substance. *(UGLY D shows a bundle of sticks.)*

CINDY: What are those?

HD: They're almost stick-like in nature.

UGLY D: They're sticks. *(Beat)*

HD: Huh. *(Moving on. . . gesturing yonder)* Looks like Gold's got a witness.

UGLY D: Next door neighbor. Was on his way home and was first on the scene.

(They head over to GOLD, who has been questioning PINOCCHIO. PINOCCHIO is a normal-looking guy, except for his outrageously long nose.)

CINDY: Hey there, Goldie.

GOLD: I'm guessing you wanna meet our new friend. Tell them exactly what you told me.

HD: Whatsyername, Dumbo.

PINOCCHIO: Uhh, I'm ... Marcus. *(Suddenly PINOCCHIO experiences noticeable nose pain. He puts his hand to it.)* Ow . . . Okay. I was walking home from a ... doctor's appointment . . . and I suddenly heard this noise. Like someone dropped a box of toothpicks. I look up and I see that mess over there. And that's it.

CINDY: Did you see anything besides the pile of sticks?

PINOCCHIO: No, no, that's all. *(Nose pain again.)* Ow.

CINDY: Is everything all right, sir?

PINOCCHIO: Yeah, everything's fine. I feel great. *(Nose pain.)* Ow.

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HD: *(The detectives are suspicious. H.D. has an idea.)* Marcus, let me ask you . . . What's the square root of sixty-four?

PINOCCHIO: Eight.

HD: What do you call a group of geese?

PINOCCHIO: A gaggle.

HD: How often do you work out at the gym?

PINOCCHIO: Twice a day. *(Nose pain.)* Ow.

CINDY: Mind telling us what's going on, "Marcus"?

HD: Howsabout telling us who you really are, Namey McFake.

PINOCCHIO: Okay, fine. FINE. *(Beat.)* My name isn't Marcus. *(Beat.)* It's Pinocchio. *(Pause.)* I'm what you'd call a test tube kid. There's this rebel scientist my "dad" who created me, and for some reason decided it would be a brilliant idea to endow me with an unbelievably enormous honker. So he merged the DNA of a human and an anteater, and tadahhhh! Oh, and as if that wasn't enough, Doctor Frankenstupid thought it might be, I don't know . . . fun? A challenge? . . . if my nose were connected to nerve endings in my brain. When I lie about anything, my trunk here grows three inches.

GOLD: I don't understand. When you lied before, it didn't look like your nose grew; it looked like you were in pain.

PINOCCHIO: Yeah, well, I can explain that. I wasn't at the doctor for a routine checkup, if ya get my meaning. Right after getting my nose "taken care of," the doctor warned me that my nerve endings would still be sensitive to lies.

GOLD: **(Pg 56)** If you got a nose job, why is it still long?

PINOCCHIO: It actually used to be ten feet longer-because of my career.

GOLD: What do you do?

PINOCCHIO: I'm running for President. *(Double-take to audience)*

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CAPTAIN: **(Pg 55-56)** *(CAPTAIN storms in. She has a hook for a hand. She's livid. She speaks extremely quickly and to the point.)* You two better have some news. We've got two

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downed buildings and zero arrests. I got the commissioner, the mayor, and Governor Grimm, all breathin' down my neck - You two had better track down whoever nixed the straw and the sticks and you better book 'em. You hear me? You book 'em. Now look here- the 911 call just came in from the vics; we're bringin' 'em down to HQ for questioning.

CINDY: Who are they?

CAPTAIN: Pigs. They're pigs.

HD: Cops?

CAPTAIN: Real pigs, you nitwit. Swine, hogs, ham. It's a quarter till. By eleven, I want answers, I want arrests, I want something! Or I will put you both on unpaid suspension faster than you can say "unpaid suspension." *(CAPTAIN storms out; Cindy and HD drop their questioning of Pinocchio and exit also)*

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(Pg 59-62) CHUH-CHUNK: Chuh-chunk. **LOCATION:** High Rise East construction site. **TIME:** 10:42 A.M.

MERM: So, let's review your story. Pig One, you were alone in your straw house; Wolf approaches the house; knocks it down.

PIG 1: Yeah. Kept sayin' he'd blow my house in, which, sounded a little weird. I told him to hold on, that I was shavin'-y'know, the really tough part right here *(Indicates his chin area.)* and then before I know it, bam, my house is kaput. I was freakin' out, right? So I curly-tail it to my bro's.

PIG 2: He showed up all discombob-uh-lated. Pork almighty . . . Same thing, I'm shavin', and the hairy guy shows up with that fan-a-his, and before ya know it, my bachelor pad's yardwaste.

PIG 3: They arrived at my doorstep, utterly frazzled . . .

STILTSKIN: At which point, the perpetrator arrived, attempted identical fan-powered destruction, but failed.

MERM: What about this Wolf character? You know him?

PIG 3: We did. He was the highest bidder on the contract for all three of our houses. But all of

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us withdrew at the last minute . . .

PIG 2: We saw him and that poor girl in the red hoodie on Judge Judy. So we certainly didn't want any association with a convicted felon.

STILTSKIN: One thing I'm not clear on: Why the disparity in the composition of your respective residences?

PIG 2: It's a simple story, really. See, Maw and Paw passed away about 10 years back.

PIG 1: Luau . . . *(The PIGS pause for a somber moment of reflection.)*

PIG 3: And they left behind a sizable trust fund for each of us.

PIG 2: Problem is, me and Pig One, we got our vices. Me, I invested mosta my inheritance as the executive producer of Kim Kardashian's debut album.

PIG 1: This little piggy went to Vegas.

PIG 2: He lost everything on the roulette wheel.

PIG 3: I invested my inheritance in a new condominium-replete with fortified Ukrainian stainless steel, state-of-the-art alarm system, and most importantly: wind-proof foundation. I, too, no longer have money.

PIG 2: But at least we have each other!

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(Pg 62-64) *(STILTSKIN and MERM across from WOLF and Defense Attorney PEEP.)*

CHUH-CHUNK: Chuh-chunk. **LOCATION:** Plea-bargain session. **TIME:** 1:13 P.M.

STILTSKIN: We're coming in full-steam on this one: Two counts each of malicious destruction of property and reckless endangerment. Nothing less.

PEEP: My client pleads not guilty to all counts.

STILTSKIN: Oh, come off it, Peep. No jury out there would swallow that even if it was corn-battered and served on a stick. We've got eyewitness testimony of your client fleeing the scene with a fan, his personal effects in the rubble, we've got motive, opportunity, and let's not forget the guy's got a rap sheet.

MERM: Picnic-basket theft, nursing home B&E, impersonation of the aged -- and I'm just getting warmed up.

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PEEP: For each of those crimes, my client was falsely accused.

MERM: Exactly. That's why his first and middle names are Big and Bad.

WOLF: That's not my name. *(PEEP whispers in WOLF's ear.)* No, it's okay. I wanna talk. . . My name is B.B. Wolf, yes, but that stands for Bernard Bartholomew Wolf. After the Riding Hood incident, the tabloids invented "Big Bad." I'm not bad, and I'm certainly not big. I'm just a wolf who always seems to end up at the wrong place at the wrong time. . .

STILTSKIN: If you're insistent you're not guilty, why were you at the scene of each crime with a fan?

PEEP: Again, my client has already explained to the police that he received three invitations to BYOF parties on Facebook.

STILTSKIN: And again, we found no such invitation.

WOLF: How many times do I have to get arrested for crimes I don't commit? First the Little Red misunderstanding, then the whole mix-up with that Peter kid, and now this! I can't take it anymore!

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(Pg 67) CHUH-CHUNK: Chuh-chunk. **LOCATION:** Courtroom. **TIME:** 4:30 P.M.

JUDGE: (Pg 69-70) Order!! I will have order!! Prosecution, present your next witness.

STILTSKIN: We call Pigs 1 through 3. *(The PIGS all take the stand together.)*

BAILIFF: Do you swear to tell the truth the whole truth and nothing but the truth, so help you Goose?

PIGS: We do.

STILTSKIN: Now ... the members of the jury have already heard a detailed, point-by-point analysis of today's horrifying events. But does such an analysis convey the pure emotional turmoil that you three had to endure? . . . *(The pigs don't understand)* I'll rephrase. Are you afraid of the Big Bad Wolf?

PIG 1: The Big Bad Wolf?

PIG 3: The Big Bad Wolf?

PEEP: Objection!

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STILTSKIN: Are you afraid of Bernard Bartholomew Wolf?

PIG 1: Tra la la la la. *(Use a similar rhythm as the song*)*

PIG 3: You'll have to excuse my brother. He is speaking in an archaic version of Pig Latin. "Tra la la la la" roughly translates into English as . . . "Yes."

STILTSKIN: And would you describe that fear?

PIG 2: It was terrifyin'. I was just shavin' like any other day, and then outta nowhere this ferocious beast walked right up to my front door and blew my house in.

(An ominous sound effect. The lights suddenly narrow to STILTSKIN. Echoes of the characters)

PIG 2: ***Walked right up to my front door, front door, front door***

ZELLE: ***Perp struck the property from the rear, rear, rear***

UGLY D: ***. . . approach on the building from the backside, backside, backside.***

PIG 3: ***I, too, no longer have money, money, money.***

STILTSKIN: *(Suddenly)* Objection!

JUDGE: Mr. Stiltskin, did you just object to your own line of questioning?

STILTSKIN: Indeed, I did, Your Honor. Indeed, I did.

JUDGE: I'll allow it.

STILTSKIN: Pigs Number 1 and 2 ... In your testimony just now, you revealed to this court that the defendant approached your front door in order to topple your comically flimsy houses with an industrial fan.

PIG 1 / PIG 2: Yeah. / Yes sir.

STILTSKIN: But the crime scene investigators have confirmed that the point of attack took place from the rear of each house ... *(The PIGS are frozen, unflinching.)* Therefore, it is my supposition that you three pigs staged the destruction of your homes, knowing you could easily frame a convicted wolf en criminal, and in the end, walk away free pigs having collected on the windfall of insurance money you so desperately desire. *(STILTSKIN gets in the PIGS' faces.)* That is my supposition!! That is what really happened!! How do you plead?!

PIGS: Okay okay! All right! We did it! Guilty . . . Guilty . . .

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PIG 1: We were broke! We needed the money so badly. I haven't bet on [anything] in almost 48 hours.

PIG 2: And KimKard lied to me! She promised that her music would bridge the generation gap and end world hunger with its hypnotic funky rhythms! And that was false! Neither of those things happened!

JUDGE: Bailiffs, take them away.

PIG 3: *(As he exits in handcuffs)* Well-played, Stiltskin. Well-played . . .

SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

2008 National Qualifier
2009 National Qualifier
2012 National Qualifier
2013 National Qualifier
2015 National Qualifier
2016 National Qualifier
2020 National Qualifier
2023 National Qualifier - MS
NIETOC
CA State Qualifier
KS State Qualifier

****Music to "Who's Afraid of the Big Bad Wolf" can be found here:***
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ShE27Hst_NM

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